

FIELD EDITION / SE_QLD / 2026

2026 observing almanac

HORIZON	EDITION	SCOPE
South East Queensland, Australia	2026	Night planning, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets and events

Priority observations

NO.	DATE	CATEGORY	OBSERVATION	RATING
01	30 Mar 2026	Milky Way	Milky Way core window 2h 35m with 89° altitude.	EXCELLENT
02	5 Nov 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta 67° altitude; magnitude 6.8.	EXCELLENT
03	1 Jan 2026	Planets	Neptune Best monthly date at 46° altitude.	EXCELLENT
04	3 Mar 2026	Eclipses	Total lunar eclipse Visible at maximum; umbral magnitude 1.15.	EXCELLENT
05	28 Mar 2026	Comets	Comet 43P 68° altitude; magnitude 17.2.	GOOD
06	12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; 2° altitude predawn.	GOOD

Monthly sheets give local dates and times. CSV tables: [data/index.html](#).

ANNUAL INDEX

Annual summary

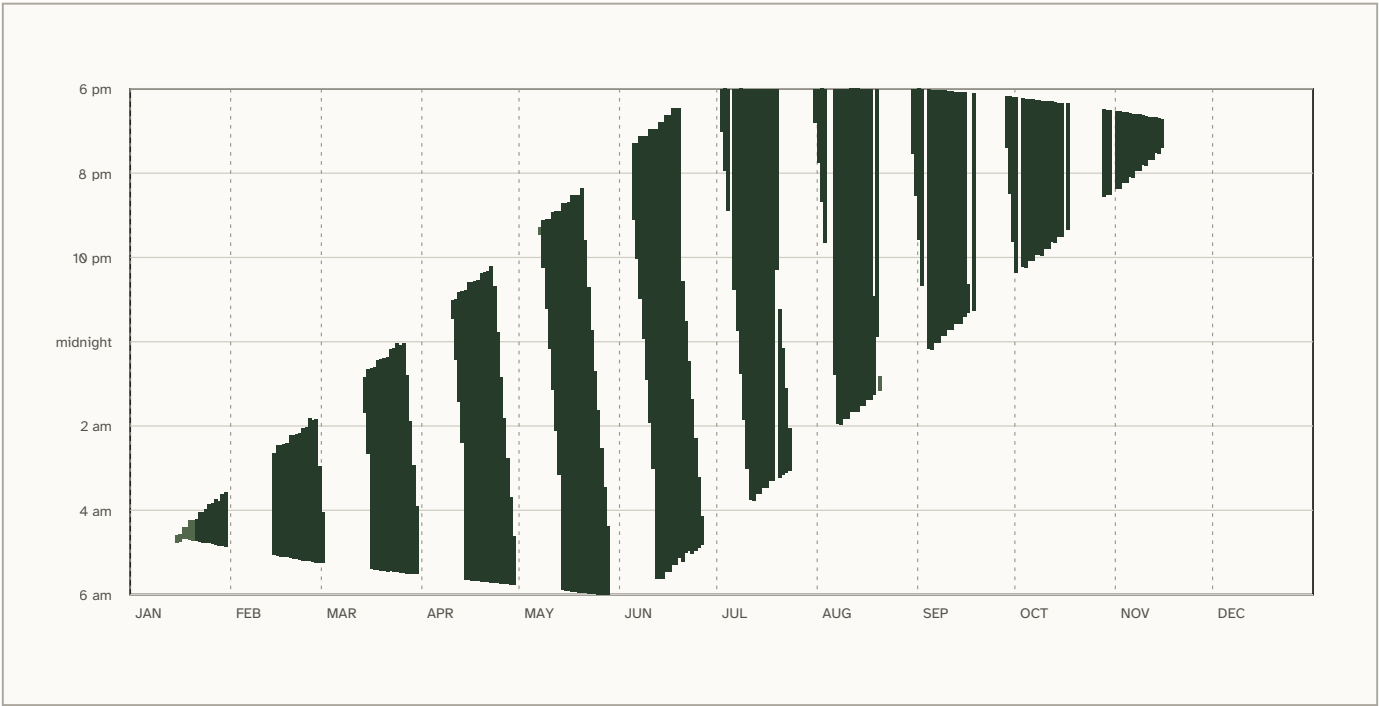
The principal observing lead, darkest low-Moon interval and darkest lunar date for each month.

MONTH	EVENT OR TARGET	BEST LOW-MOON DARKNESS	DARKEST MOON	RATING
01 JANUARY	PLANET OPPOSITION Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.	23 Jan 2026 · 9h 33m	Darkest Moon 19 Jan 2026 · 0% illuminated	GOOD
02 FEBRUARY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 28 Feb 2026, from 2:57 am to 5:14 am, reaching 65°.	21 Feb 2026 · 10h 17m	Darkest Moon 18 Feb 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
03 MARCH	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 29 Mar 2026, from 2:56 am to 5:31 am, reaching 89°.	23 Mar 2026 · 11h 08m	Darkest Moon 19 Mar 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
04 APRIL	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 16 Apr 2026, from 10:35 pm to 5:40 am, reaching 89°.	21 Apr 2026 · 11h 52m	Darkest Moon 18 Apr 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
05 MAY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 May 2026, from 8:21 pm to 5:57 am, reaching 89°.	20 May 2026 · 12h 26m	Darkest Moon 17 May 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
06 JUNE	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 13 Jun 2026, from 6:47 pm to 5:37 am, reaching 89°.	19 Jun 2026 · 12h 42m	Darkest Moon 15 Jun 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
07 JULY	GALACTIC CENTRE Galactic Centre viewing is best on 16 Jul 2026, from 5:37 pm to 3:27 am, reaching 89°.	11 Jul 2026 · 12h 36m	Darkest Moon 15 Jul 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
08 AUGUST	METEOR SHOWER Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, though the radiant stays low from this horizon.	10 Aug 2026 · 12h 08m	Darkest Moon 13 Aug 2026 · 1% illuminated	GOOD
09 SEPTEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.	8 Sep 2026 · 11h 27m	Darkest Moon 11 Sep 2026 · 0% illuminated	EXCELLENT
10 OCTOBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Saturn reaches opposition on 4 Oct 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.	7 Oct 2026 · 10h 40m	Darkest Moon 11 Oct 2026 · 1% illuminated	EXCELLENT
11 NOVEMBER	PLANET OPPOSITION Uranus reaches opposition on 25 Nov 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.	6 Nov 2026 · 9h 51m	Darkest Moon 9 Nov 2026 · 0% illuminated	GOOD
12 DECEMBER	METEOR SHOWER Geminids peak on 14 Dec 2026 under 22% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 23° before dawn.	5 Dec 2026 · 9h 17m	Darkest Moon 9 Dec 2026 · 0% illuminated	GOOD

ANNUAL NIGHT CHART

Galactic Centre observing time

Each vertical trace is a usable core-viewing interval. Dates run left to right; local night time runs downward from 6 pm to 6 am.



Only intervals that pass astronomical darkness, Moon and core-altitude constraints are shown.

Best session by month

MONTH	DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALTITUDE	RATING
January	30 Jan 2026	3:35 am to 4:52 am	1h 17m	36°	EXCELLENT
February	27 Feb 2026	1:50 am to 5:14 am	3h 24m	65°	EXCELLENT
March	26 Mar 2026	12:02 am to 5:29 am	5h 28m	88°	EXCELLENT
April	22 Apr 2026	10:13 pm to 5:43 am	7h 30m	89°	EXCELLENT
May	20 May 2026	8:21 pm to 5:57 am	9h 36m	89°	EXCELLENT
June	13 Jun 2026	6:47 pm to 5:37 am	10h 50m	89°	EXCELLENT
July	11 Jul 2026	5:35 pm to 3:45 am	10h 10m	88°	EXCELLENT
August	8 Aug 2026	5:48 pm to 1:58 am	8h 10m	89°	EXCELLENT
September	4 Sep 2026	6:00 pm to 12:10 am	6h 10m	89°	EXCELLENT
October	1 Oct 2026	6:12 pm to 10:22 pm	4h 10m	73°	EXCELLENT
November	1 Nov 2026	6:32 pm to 8:22 pm	1h 50m	42°	EXCELLENT
December	No qualifying session				

MONTH 01

January 2026

GOOD

Jupiter reaches opposition on 11 Jan 2026 and is highest around 12:00 am.

NEW MOON 19 Jan 2026	FULL MOON 4 Jan 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jan 2026	DARKNESS 7:15 pm to 4:39 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
23 Jan 2026	7:13 pm to 4:46 am	9h 33m	20%
22 Jan 2026	7:13 pm to 4:45 am	9h 32m	12%
21 Jan 2026	7:13 pm to 4:44 am	9h 31m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
30 Jan 2026	3:35 am to 4:52 am	1h 17m	36°	EXCELLENT
29 Jan 2026	3:37 am to 4:51 am	1h 14m	35°	EXCELLENT
27 Jan 2026	3:44 am to 4:49 am	1h 06m	33°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	1 Jan 7:30 pm	46°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	1 Jan 7:30 pm	46°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Uranus	28 Jan 7:00 pm	43°	GOOD
Evening	Venus	31 Jan 7:00 pm	1°	POOR
Overnight	Jupiter	2 Jan 12:30 am	40°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	1 Jan 4:30 am	5°	POOR
Predawn	Mars	31 Jan 5:00 am	0°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
10 Jan 2026	Planetary events	Jupiter opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
1 Jan 2026	Occultations	HIP 22400 lunar occultation	10:30 pm to 11:53 pm; Moon at 33° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
3 Jan 2026	Meteor showers	Quadrantids	Peak conditions: 99% Moon illumination; -6° altitude predawn.	POOR

MONTH 02

February 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 28 Feb 2026, from 2:57 am to 5:14 am, reaching 65°.

NEW MOON 18 Feb 2026	FULL MOON 2 Feb 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Feb 2026	DARKNESS 6:58 pm to 5:05 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
21 Feb 2026	6:52 pm to 5:09 am	10h 17m	16%
20 Feb 2026	6:53 pm to 5:09 am	10h 15m	9%
19 Feb 2026	6:54 pm to 5:08 am	10h 14m	4%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
27 Feb 2026	1:50 am to 5:14 am	3h 24m	65°	EXCELLENT
25 Feb 2026	1:49 am to 5:12 am	3h 24m	63°	EXCELLENT
26 Feb 2026	1:52 am to 5:13 am	3h 21m	64°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Uranus	1 Feb 7:00 pm	43°	GOOD
Evening	Neptune	1 Feb 7:00 pm	28°	GOOD
Evening	Saturn	1 Feb 7:00 pm	28°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	13 Feb 7:00 pm	4°	POOR
Evening	Venus	7 Feb 7:00 pm	1°	POOR
Overnight	Jupiter	4 Feb 10:00 pm	40°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	28 Feb 5:00 am	2°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
19 Feb 2026	Occultations	Mercury lunar occultation	7:47 am; Moon at 10° altitude for the first listed contact.	GOOD
20 Feb 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 18.1° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Feb 2026	Occultations	HIP 37704 lunar occultation	1:05 am; Moon at 28° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 03

March 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 29 Mar 2026, from 2:56 am to 5:31 am, reaching 89°.

NEW MOON 19 Mar 2026	FULL MOON 4 Mar 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Mar 2026	DARKNESS 6:29 pm to 5:23 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
23 Mar 2026	6:20 pm to 5:28 am	11h 08m	22%
22 Mar 2026	6:21 pm to 5:27 am	11h 06m	14%
21 Mar 2026	6:22 pm to 5:27 am	11h 04m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
26 Mar 2026	12:02 am to 5:29 am	5h 28m	88°	EXCELLENT
24 Mar 2026	12:03 am to 5:28 am	5h 26m	88°	EXCELLENT
25 Mar 2026	12:05 am to 5:29 am	5h 24m	88°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	29 Mar 6:30 pm	40°	GOOD
Evening	Uranus	6 Mar 6:30 pm	35°	GOOD
Evening	Saturn	6 Mar 6:30 pm	8°	POOR
Evening	Neptune	6 Mar 6:30 pm	7°	POOR
Evening	Venus	6 Mar 6:30 pm	6°	POOR
Predawn	Mercury	31 Mar 5:30 am	21°	FAIR
Predawn	Mars	31 Mar 5:30 am	11°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
19 Mar 2026	Minor planets	7 Iris	61° altitude; magnitude 9.4.	EXCELLENT
3 Mar 2026	Eclipses	Total lunar eclipse	Visible at maximum; umbral magnitude 1.15.	EXCELLENT
28 Mar 2026	Comets	Comet 43P	68° altitude; magnitude 17.2.	GOOD

MONTH 04

April 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 16 Apr 2026, from 10:35 pm to 5:40 am, reaching 89°.

NEW MOON 18 Apr 2026	FULL MOON 2 Apr 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Apr 2026	DARKNESS 5:56 pm to 5:39 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
21 Apr 2026	5:50 pm to 5:42 am	11h 52m	19%
20 Apr 2026	5:51 pm to 5:42 am	11h 51m	11%
19 Apr 2026	5:52 pm to 5:41 am	11h 49m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
22 Apr 2026	10:13 pm to 5:43 am	7h 30m	89°	EXCELLENT
21 Apr 2026	10:20 pm to 5:42 am	7h 22m	88°	EXCELLENT
20 Apr 2026	10:21 pm to 5:42 am	7h 21m	89°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	6 Apr 6:00 pm	40°	GOOD
Evening	Uranus	2 Apr 6:00 pm	24°	FAIR
Evening	Venus	2 Apr 6:00 pm	9°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	30 Apr 5:30 am	26°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	2 Apr 5:30 am	21°	FAIR
Predawn	Saturn	30 Apr 5:30 am	20°	FAIR
Predawn	Mars	30 Apr 5:30 am	14°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
8 Apr 2026	Minor planets	15 Eunomia	77° altitude; magnitude 10.0.	EXCELLENT
4 Apr 2026	Comets	Comet 29P	65° altitude; magnitude 17.4.	GOOD
4 Apr 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 27.8° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 05

May 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 20 May 2026, from 8:21 pm to 5:57 am, reaching 89°.

NEW MOON 17 May 2026	FULL MOON 2 May 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 May 2026	DARKNESS 5:33 pm to 5:55 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
20 May 2026	5:31 pm to 5:57 am	12h 26m	16%
19 May 2026	5:31 pm to 5:57 am	12h 26m	9%
18 May 2026	5:32 pm to 5:56 am	12h 25m	3%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
20 May 2026	8:21 pm to 5:57 am	9h 36m	89°	EXCELLENT
19 May 2026	8:31 pm to 5:57 am	9h 26m	88°	EXCELLENT
18 May 2026	8:32 pm to 5:56 am	9h 25m	88°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Jupiter	4 May 5:30 pm	38°	GOOD
Evening	Venus	31 May 5:30 pm	20°	FAIR
Evening	Uranus	4 May 5:30 pm	8°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	31 May 6:00 am	54°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	31 May 6:00 am	48°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	31 May 6:00 am	22°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	5 May 6:00 am	7°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
28 May 2026	Comets	Comet 24P	65° altitude; magnitude 17.4.	GOOD
1 May 2026	Occultations	HIP 66512 lunar occultation	3:01 am to 3:58 am; Moon at 31° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
6 May 2026	Meteor showers	Eta Aquariids	Peak conditions: 88% Moon illumination; 34° altitude predawn.	POOR

MONTH 06

June 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 13 Jun 2026, from 6:47 pm to 5:37 am, reaching 89°.

NEW MOON 15 Jun 2026	FULL MOON 1 Jun 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jun 2026	DARKNESS 5:27 pm to 6:09 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
19 Jun 2026	5:28 pm to 6:10 am	12h 42m	22%
18 Jun 2026	5:28 pm to 6:09 am	12h 42m	14%
17 Jun 2026	5:28 pm to 6:09 am	12h 42m	7%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
13 Jun 2026	6:47 pm to 5:37 am	10h 50m	89°	EXCELLENT
18 Jun 2026	6:28 pm to 5:18 am	10h 50m	89°	EXCELLENT
16 Jun 2026	6:37 pm to 5:27 am	10h 50m	88°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	30 Jun 5:30 pm	30°	GOOD
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jun 5:30 pm	28°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	20 Jun 5:30 pm	15°	POOR
Predawn	Neptune	23 Jun 6:00 am	62°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	30 Jun 6:00 am	59°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	30 Jun 6:00 am	24°	FAIR
Predawn	Uranus	30 Jun 6:00 am	21°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
16 Jun 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest eastern elongation	Evening sky; 24.5° from the Sun.	GOOD
1 Jun 2026	Occultations	HIP 81821 lunar occultation	1:33 am to 3:04 am; Moon at 68° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
1 Jun 2026	Occultations	HIP 85318 lunar occultation	6:47 pm to 7:50 pm; Moon at 15° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 07

July 2026

EXCELLENT

Galactic Centre viewing is best on 16 Jul 2026, from 5:37 pm to 3:27 am, reaching 89°.

NEW MOON 15 Jul 2026	FULL MOON 30 Jul 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Jul 2026	DARKNESS 5:37 pm to 6:10 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
11 Jul 2026	5:35 pm to 6:11 am	12h 36m	24%
12 Jul 2026	5:36 pm to 6:11 am	12h 35m	15%
13 Jul 2026	5:36 pm to 6:11 am	12h 35m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
11 Jul 2026	5:35 pm to 3:45 am	10h 10m	88°	EXCELLENT
12 Jul 2026	5:36 pm to 3:46 am	10h 10m	88°	EXCELLENT
14 Jul 2026	5:36 pm to 3:36 am	10h 00m	89°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	22 Jul 5:30 pm	38°	GOOD
Evening	Jupiter	1 Jul 5:30 pm	13°	POOR
Evening	Mercury	1 Jul 5:30 pm	10°	POOR
Overnight	Neptune	31 Jul 3:30 am	62°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Saturn	3 Jul 6:00 am	59°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	31 Jul 6:00 am	37°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Jul 6:00 am	26°	GOOD

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
2 Jul 2026	Comets	Comet 3D	76° altitude; magnitude 16.3.	GOOD
1 Jul 2026	Occultations	HIP 94643 lunar occultation	5:29 am; Moon at 24° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
8 Jul 2026	Planetary events	Neptune stationary point	Apparent motion changes direction.	FAIR

MONTH 08

August 2026

GOOD

Perseids peak on 12 Aug 2026 under 4% Moon, though the radiant stays low from this horizon.

NEW MOON 13 Aug 2026	FULL MOON 29 Aug 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Aug 2026	DARKNESS 5:51 pm to 5:53 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
10 Aug 2026	5:49 pm to 5:57 am	12h 08m	17%
11 Aug 2026	5:50 pm to 5:56 am	12h 07m	10%
12 Aug 2026	5:50 pm to 5:56 am	12h 06m	4%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
8 Aug 2026	5:48 pm to 1:58 am	8h 10m	89°	EXCELLENT
7 Aug 2026	5:48 pm to 1:56 am	8h 08m	88°	EXCELLENT
10 Aug 2026	5:49 pm to 1:49 am	8h 00m	89°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	26 Aug 6:00 pm	38°	GOOD
Overnight	Neptune	31 Aug 1:30 am	62°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	31 Aug 2:00 am	59°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Uranus	30 Aug 5:30 am	41°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	19 Aug 6:00 am	29°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	1 Aug 6:00 am	9°	POOR
Predawn	Jupiter	31 Aug 5:30 am	8°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
19 Aug 2026	Minor planets	3 Juno	70° altitude; magnitude 9.2.	EXCELLENT
12 Aug 2026	Meteor showers	Perseids	Peak conditions: 4% Moon illumination; 2° altitude predawn.	GOOD
2 Aug 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.5° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 09

September 2026

EXCELLENT

Neptune reaches opposition on 26 Sep 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.

NEW MOON 11 Sep 2026	FULL MOON 27 Sep 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Sep 2026	DARKNESS 6:05 pm to 5:21 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
8 Sep 2026	6:02 pm to 5:29 am	11h 27m	20%
9 Sep 2026	6:02 pm to 5:28 am	11h 26m	12%
10 Sep 2026	6:03 pm to 5:27 am	11h 24m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
4 Sep 2026	6:00 pm to 12:10 am	6h 10m	89°	EXCELLENT
5 Sep 2026	6:01 pm to 12:11 am	6h 10m	88°	EXCELLENT
6 Sep 2026	6:01 pm to 12:01 am	6h 00m	88°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Venus	1 Sep 6:00 pm	38°	GOOD
Evening	Mercury	25 Sep 6:00 pm	17°	FAIR
Overnight	Neptune	29 Sep 11:30 pm	63°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Saturn	30 Sep 12:00 am	60°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	30 Sep 3:30 am	41°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	16 Sep 5:30 am	30°	GOOD
Predawn	Jupiter	30 Sep 5:00 am	21°	FAIR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
26 Sep 2026	Planetary events	Neptune opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
1 Sep 2026	Occultations	HIP 5417 lunar occultation	12:42 am to 1:28 am; Moon at 44° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR
2 Sep 2026	Occultations	HIP 9449 lunar occultation	12:54 am to 2:12 am; Moon at 34° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 10

October 2026

EXCELLENT

Saturn reaches opposition on 4 Oct 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.

NEW MOON 11 Oct 2026	FULL MOON 26 Oct 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Oct 2026	DARKNESS 6:20 pm to 4:47 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
7 Oct 2026	6:16 pm to 4:56 am	10h 40m	22%
8 Oct 2026	6:16 pm to 4:55 am	10h 38m	14%
9 Oct 2026	6:17 pm to 4:54 am	10h 37m	8%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
1 Oct 2026	6:12 pm to 10:22 pm	4h 10m	73°	EXCELLENT
3 Oct 2026	6:13 pm to 10:13 pm	4h 00m	71°	EXCELLENT
4 Oct 2026	6:14 pm to 10:14 pm	4h 00m	70°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	28 Oct 9:30 pm	63°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Venus	1 Oct 6:30 pm	21°	FAIR
Evening	Mercury	15 Oct 6:30 pm	17°	FAIR
Overnight	Saturn	29 Oct 10:00 pm	61°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	30 Oct 1:30 am	42°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Oct 4:30 am	36°	GOOD
Predawn	Jupiter	31 Oct 4:30 am	35°	GOOD

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
2 Oct 2026	Comets	Comet 10P	84° altitude; magnitude 13.8.	GOOD
4 Oct 2026	Planetary events	Saturn opposition	Visible for most of the night.	GOOD
1 Oct 2026	Occultations	HIP 17181 lunar occultation	12:33 am to 1:22 am; Moon at 27° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

MONTH 11

November 2026

GOOD

Uranus reaches opposition on 25 Nov 2026 and is highest around 11:30 pm.

NEW MOON 9 Nov 2026	FULL MOON 25 Nov 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Nov 2026	DARKNESS 6:43 pm to 4:21 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
6 Nov 2026	6:36 pm to 4:27 am	9h 51m	18%
7 Nov 2026	6:36 pm to 4:26 am	9h 50m	11%
8 Nov 2026	6:37 pm to 4:26 am	9h 48m	5%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
1 Nov 2026	6:32 pm to 8:22 pm	1h 50m	42°	EXCELLENT
2 Nov 2026	6:32 pm to 8:22 pm	1h 50m	41°	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	6:33 pm to 8:13 pm	1h 40m	40°	EXCELLENT

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	28 Nov 7:30 pm	63°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	26 Nov 8:00 pm	62°	EXCELLENT
Overnight	Uranus	27 Nov 11:30 pm	42°	GOOD
Predawn	Jupiter	23 Nov 4:30 am	46°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Mars	23 Nov 4:30 am	45°	GOOD
Predawn	Venus	23 Nov 4:30 am	22°	FAIR
Predawn	Mercury	23 Nov 4:30 am	8°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
5 Nov 2026	Minor planets	4 Vesta	67° altitude; magnitude 6.8.	EXCELLENT
3 Nov 2026	Occultations	Jupiter lunar occultation	9:57 am to 10:20 am; Moon at 28° altitude for the first listed contact.	GOOD
21 Nov 2026	Planetary events	Mercury greatest western elongation	Morning sky; 19.6° from the Sun.	GOOD

MONTH 12

December 2026

GOOD

Geminids peak on 14 Dec 2026 under 22% Moon, with the radiant reaching about 23° before dawn.

NEW MOON 9 Dec 2026	FULL MOON 24 Dec 2026	REFERENCE NIGHT 15 Dec 2026	DARKNESS 7:07 pm to 4:18 am
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Best low-Moon dark periods

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MOON
5 Dec 2026	6:59 pm to 4:17 am	9h 17m	22%
6 Dec 2026	7:00 pm to 4:17 am	9h 16m	14%
7 Dec 2026	7:01 pm to 4:17 am	9h 16m	9%

Galactic Centre sessions

DATE	LOCAL INTERVAL	DURATION	MAX ALT.	RATING
No qualifying core session is listed.				

Planet visibility

PERIOD	PLANET	DATE / TIME	ALT.	RATING
Evening	Neptune	5 Dec 7:00 pm	63°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Saturn	4 Dec 7:30 pm	62°	EXCELLENT
Evening	Uranus	26 Dec 9:30 pm	42°	GOOD
Predawn	Mars	31 Dec 4:00 am	52°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Jupiter	18 Dec 4:00 am	49°	EXCELLENT
Predawn	Venus	31 Dec 4:30 am	32°	GOOD
Predawn	Mercury	13 Dec 4:30 am	5°	POOR

Events and observing leads

DATE	CATEGORY	TARGET OR EVENT	FIELD NOTE	RATING
14 Dec 2026	Meteor showers	Geminids	Peak conditions: 22% Moon illumination; 23° altitude predawn.	GOOD
25 Dec 2026	Comets	Comet 11P	55° altitude; magnitude 17.5.	GOOD
7 Dec 2026	Occultations	HIP 73588 lunar occultation	4:01 am; Moon at 12° altitude for the first listed contact.	FAIR

REFERENCE

Using this field edition

Time and place

All displayed dates and times are local to South East Queensland, Australia. Overnight intervals begin on the printed date and may end after midnight on the following civil date.

Ratings

Text labels repeat every colour-coded rating for monochrome printing.

Low-Moon darkness

Intervals occur within astronomical darkness and apply the edition's Moon constraint. They are not interchangeable with Galactic Centre visibility, which additionally requires the core to clear the altitude threshold.

CSV tables

Full CSV tables for twilight, Moon, Galactic Centre, planets, satellites, minor planets, comets and events are available from the web data index.

Sources and scope

- Solar, lunar, planetary and Galactic Centre circumstances are calculated for the named observing horizon.
- Jupiter and Saturn satellite positions use NASA JPL Horizons.
- Meteor and event sources are listed in the downloadable tables.
- This PDF does not include live weather, cloud, smoke, local obstruction or artificial sky brightness.

Web data index: [data/index.html](#)